



November 21, 2025

The Honorable Debbie-Anne A. Reese, Secretary
Federal Energy Regulatory Commission
888 First Street, N.E.
Washington, D.C. 20426

Re: Comments of the AI Supply Chain Alliance in Response to the Secretary of Energy's Letter Regarding the Interconnection of Large Loads Pursuant to the Secretary's Authority under Section 403 of the Department of Energy Organization Act and Advance Notice of Proposed Rulemaking under RM26-4-000

Dear Secretary Reese:

The AI Supply Chain Alliance ("AI-SCA") respectfully submits these comments in response to the Secretary of Energy's (Secretary) letter and directive, issued pursuant to Section 403 of the Department of Energy Organization Act, requesting that the Commission initiate an advance notice of proposed rulemaking ("ANOPR") for consideration and final action in Docket No. RM26-4-000.

As representatives of the digital infrastructure ecosystem, members of the AI-SCA appreciate the opportunity to provide comments on the ANOPR. The AI-SCA is a coalition spanning the full AI value chain, including AI platform providers, microchip manufacturers, server hardware, data center equipment, software developers, data center designers and operators, and power-management service providers. Data center equipment providers offer additional infrastructure, such as networking components, high-performance storage, and cooling solutions, to ensure optimal performance. Data center designers and operators play the role of

architects, constructing and managing facilities that can house these power-intensive technologies, ensuring optimal layout, airflow, and energy efficiency. The equipment and services provided by members of the AI-SCA are the people and parts that drive domestic and local economic growth in support of several of the large loads seeking to interconnect to the transmission system.

Traditional barriers, like real estate and supply chains, are no longer the primary concern for members of the AI-SCA. Instead, the primary barrier to development for AI-SCA members is ensuring timely access to electricity. Put simply, access to sufficient power – and the long lead times often associated with securing it – has become a central barrier to new economic development opportunities in the United States. Reducing interconnection timelines is now a national security and economic development imperative.

Meeting the growing demand from new, critical large loads requires accelerating interconnection processes and establishing additional pathways for large loads to connect to the transmission system in ways that manage costs and preserve long-term reliability for all customers. Approaches such as direct market access and new supply arrangements, such as co-location (or hybrid facilities), bring your own power, and behind-the-meter generation, can enable faster connection to the grid for large load customers like data centers, reshoring of manufacturing, and other industrial processes while ensuring that interconnecting customers are responsible for associated costs of network upgrades. Timely interconnection to the transmission system via existing sites with power and opportunities to quickly develop new and additional power supplies is paramount to meeting national security and economic development goals.

The AI-SCA supports the direction outlined by the Secretary and the Department of Energy to clarify and expedite interconnection procedures and agreements to ensure the timely and orderly interconnection of large loads to the transmission system. We recognize, however, that implementing uniform large load interconnection procedures and agreements across diverse types of new large loads and transmission providers will be a complex undertaking. As an initial step, the AI-SCA encourages the Commission to exercise its existing authority to determine that large load interconnection to the transmission system is a key component of open access transmission service. In addition, we urge the Commission to encourage additional parameters and information from

transmission providers to develop large load interconnection procedures that provide flexibility and that result in interconnection times that are faster than current processes.

In summary, members of the AI-SCA encourage the Commission to act expeditiously in support of open and non-discriminatory access to the transmission system and standardization of interconnection procedures and agreements for large loads to support economic growth and competition.

Respectfully Submitted,

/s/ Tom Lawler

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On behalf of AI Supply Chain Alliance